

Comprehensive Comparison: The Top 35 Strategic Selection

The following matrix ranks the elite locations for a Joliet-based operation based on composite strategic utility.

Table 4: The Strategic Utility Matrix (Top 35 Composite Ranking)

Rank	Location	Centroid (Lat, Long)	Prox	Pop	Bus	Composite Value
1	Joliet	41.5250, -88.0817 ⁶	10/10	9/10	9/10	Operational Anchor
2	Naperville	41.7639, -88.2168 ⁶	7/10	10/10	10/10	Tech/Scale Hub
3	Aurora	41.7637, -88.2901 ⁶	7/10	10/10	10/10	Industrial Hub
4	Bolingbrook	41.6986, -88.0684	8/10	8/10	9/10	Logistics Primary
5	Romeoville	41.6475, -88.0895	9/10	7/10	8/10	Logistics Secondary
6	Plainfield	41.5685, -88.1639 ⁶	9/10	8/10	7/10	Rapid Growth Node
7	Chicago (Loop)	41.8832, -87.6324 ⁶	4/10	8/10	10/10	Global Core
8	Orland Park	41.6303, -87.8539	7/10	8/10	9/10	Commercial Nexus

9	Near North Side	41.9006, -87.6331 ⁶	4/10	10/10	10/10	High-Wealth Cluster
10	Schaumburg	42.0334, -88.0834	4/10	9/10	10/10	Corporate Secondary
11	Downers Grove	41.8089, -88.0112	6/10	8/10	9/10	Regional Center
12	Tinley Park	41.5992, -87.7845	6/10	8/10	8/10	Industrial/Entertain
13	Near West Side	41.8854, -87.6474 ⁶	4/10	8/10	9/10	Emerging Tech Hub
14	Shorewood	41.5209, -88.2017	10/10	5/10	6/10	Local Service Gateway
15	New Lenox	41.5111, -87.9656	9/10	6/10	6/10	Healthcare Anchor
16	Lincoln Park	41.9219, -87.6462 ⁶	3/10	8/10	8/10	Affluent/Higher Ed
17	Lockport	41.5895, -88.0578	9/10	6/10	6/10	Historical Center
18	Austin (Chicago)	41.8919, -87.7556 ⁶	5/10	9/10	6/10	West Side Hub
19	West Town	41.8936, -87.6722	3/10	9/10	8/10	Creative Commercial
20	St. Charles	41.9139, -88.3126	5/10	7/10	7/10	Fox River Node

21	Elgin	42.0350, -88.2826	4/10	9/10	9/10	Manufacturing Hub
22	Frankfort	41.4925, -87.8484	8/10	5/10	6/10	Lifestyle/Boutique
23	Mokena	41.5311, -87.8767	8/10	5/10	6/10	Industrial Service
24	Homer Glen	41.6020, -87.9423	8/10	6/10	6/10	Medical/Retail
25	Oswego	41.6834, -88.3517	6/10	7/10	6/10	Growth/Service Node
26	Yorkville	41.6563, -88.4507 ⁶	6/10	6/10	5/10	Residential Hub
27	Lake View	41.9430, -87.6580	3/10	10/10	8/10	Dense Residential
28	Evanston	42.0451, -87.6877	3/10	9/10	9/10	Research/Academic
29	Oak Brook	41.8411, -87.9531	5/10	3/10	9/10	Professional Services
30	Rockford	42.2711, -89.0940	3/10	10/10	10/10	Regional Export Hub
31	Bloomington	40.4842, -88.9937	2/10	9/10	9/10	Insurance Central
32	Peoria	40.6936, -89.5890	1/10	9/10	10/10	Industrial Deep Port

33	DeKalb	41.9295, -88.7504	4/10	7/10	6/10	Academic/Logistics
34	Logan Square	41.9231, -87.7013 ⁶	3/10	8/10	8/10	High-Growth Urban
35	Kankakee	41.1200, -87.8611	5/10	6/10	6/10	Regional Hub South